



KillerPDF

A practical guide to the 1.8 family

Read, annotate, edit, OCR, sign, print, and save PDFs locally on Windows. This guide documents the current 1.8 application, its shortcuts, all 19 interface languages, and all 13 themes.

19

interface locales

13

themes

71

shortcut rows

THE APPLICATION

PDF work, in one place

A native Windows application with local processing and an independent PDF document engine.

**Read**

Single, Continuous, Two Page, Grid, and Book layouts. Tabs, thumbnails, bookmarks, split pane, and jump history.

**Edit**

Text boxes, covers, highlights, ink, shapes, images, signatures, stamps, links, and fillable form fields.

**Convert**

Merge, split, extract, crop, transform, flatten, render to images, and produce searchable scanned PDFs.

**Deliver**

Print preview, page ranges, N-up layout, digital signatures, and save workflows with document structure checks.

The local workflow

Your document is opened, displayed, and edited on your computer. OCR uses downloadable Tesseract models. The installed build uses the .NET 10 Desktop Runtime; the portable package includes its runtime.

EXPLORE

Read with control

The same document can be viewed several ways without changing the PDF itself.



View modes

Continuous for long reading, Single Page for focus, Two Page and Book for spreads, Grid for an overview.



Navigation

Use page keys, thumbnails, bookmarks, tabs, jump history, and a second pane to compare distant pages.

Zoom and rendering

Fit Page, Fit Width, Actual Size, and cursor-anchored zoom keep the current area in view. The page image and the interactive annotation layer are kept separate on screen.

Search and selection

Find text across a document, move between results, select page text, and copy what you need. For image-only scans, Make Searchable PDF adds a text layer with OCR.

CREATE

Annotate and revise

Marks remain editable in the live session and are committed through the save workflow.



Text and covers

Add text, or replace existing words using a linked cover and text box.



Highlights and ink

Mark passages, draw freehand, add lines and shapes, then adjust color and opacity.



Images and signatures

Place pictures and signatures, move and resize them, or create page stamps.



Pages and links

Crop, rotate, reorder, split, merge, extract, and add links.

WORK WITH SCANS

Forms that save. Scans that search.

Interactive fields

Fill existing PDF form fields, add a fillable text field with F, and save the completed document. The engine preserves form structure while writing.

On-device OCR

OCR Page copies text from the current page. OCR Region reads a selected area. Make Searchable PDF adds an invisible text layer to a scanned document. Models download on first use and remain cached.

Model choices

The OCR catalog has 19 language models, including Norwegian, Brazilian Portuguese, Ukrainian, and Vietnamese. Standard and High Quality downloads are available.

FINISH

Save, print, and share

**Save**

Write a new copy with edits while checking the document structure. Keep the original if recovery is required.

**Print**

Preview page ranges, printer settings, scaling, alignment, color, copies, duplex, and N-up layouts.

**Export**

Extract pages, split documents, flatten a copy, or render pages as PNG and JPEG images.

**Automate**

Use the command line for merging, extraction, OCR, rendering, printing, and batch resave.

UNDER THE HOOD

A separate PDF engine

The KillerPDF.Engine is the UI-free .NET library used by the desktop application.



Document structure

Parsing, object graphs, page trees, forms, annotations, metadata, and cross references.



Writing

Incremental updates and full rewrites, with validation before output.



Security

Encryption, permission checks, decryption, signing, and signature verification.



Rendering

PDFium draws pages for viewing, print preview, image export, and OCR input.

Validation

KillerPDF checks saved PDFs with structural and standards-oriented tooling. Validation results describe the specific version and corpus tested; they are not a guarantee that every possible PDF is supported.

KEYBOARD REFERENCE

File, tools, and editing

Generated from the same shortcut table used by the in-app list and keyboard map.

FILE

Ctrl+O	Open
Ctrl+S	Save
Ctrl+Shift+S	Save As
Ctrl+W	Close file
Ctrl+Shift+W	Close other tabs
Ctrl+Q	Close all
Ctrl+N	New blank document
Ctrl+P	Print
Ctrl+D / F4	Document info
Shift+F4	Show current file size

TOOLS

V	Select
1 (or T)	Text
2 (or H)	Highlight
3 (or L or U)	Line
4	Shapes
5 (or D)	Draw
6 (or I)	Add Image
7 (or G)	Signature
8 (or C)	Crop
9 (or R)	Transform
Ctrl+R	Rotate Page CW
Ctrl+Shift+R	Rotate Page CCW
0 (or S)	Stamp Pages
F	Fillable text field

EDIT

Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+Y	Redo
Ctrl+Shift+Z	Redo
Ctrl+C	Copy selected text
Ctrl+V	Paste image / text
Ctrl+B / I / U	Bold, italic, underline
Delete	Delete selected annotation
F2	Rename
Enter / Esc	Confirm / cancel text or crop
Menu / Shift+F10	Context menu at selection

HELP

F1 / Ctrl+?	This shortcut list
F12	About dialog
Ctrl+Shift+K	Toggle keyboard shortcuts

KEYBOARD REFERENCE

Navigation and view

Generated from the same shortcut table used by the in-app list and keyboard map.

NAV

Left / Right or PgUp/PgDn	Previous / next page
%home% / %end%	First / last page
Alt+Left / Alt+Right	Back / forward (jump history)
Up / Down	Scroll (flips page at the edges)
Ctrl+Scroll	Zoom in / out (cursor-anchored)
Ctrl+= / Ctrl+-	Zoom in / out
Ctrl+0	Reset zoom to 100%
Ctrl+1 / 2 / 3	Actual size / fit width / fit page
Middle drag	Pan view
Space + drag	Pan view
F9	Toggle sidebar
Shift+F9	Move sidebar left / right
Ctrl+Tab	Next tab (Shift: previous)
Ctrl+Shift+Tab	Previous tab

OCR

Ctrl+Shift+0	OCR Page (Copy Text)
Ctrl+Shift+I	OCR Region...

VIEW

F5	Continuous
F6	Single Page
F7	Two Page
B	Book layout
F8	Grid
F10	Split pane - two documents side by
F11 / Esc	Full screen
Alt+M	Hide toolbar
N	Invert document colors
Shift+N	Invert images too
Ctrl+Shift+= / - / 0	Zoom the whole app (accessibility)
Wheel on logo	Zoom the whole app (accessibility)
Ctrl+Shift+1-6	Toolbar appearance

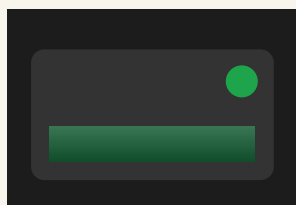
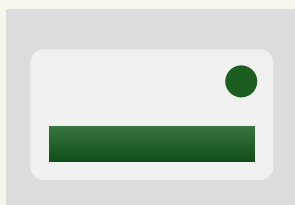
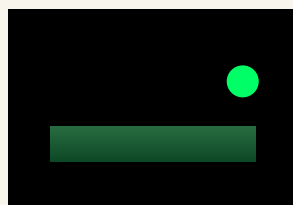
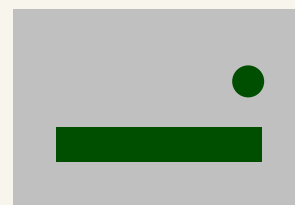
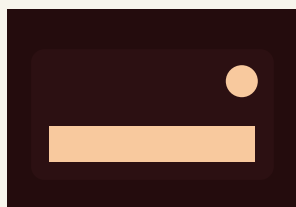
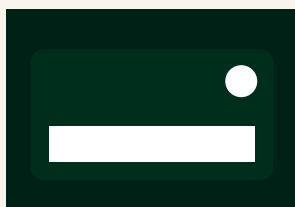
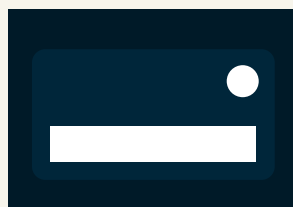
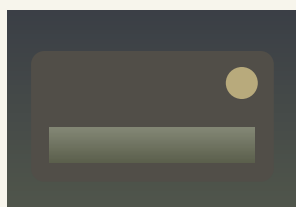
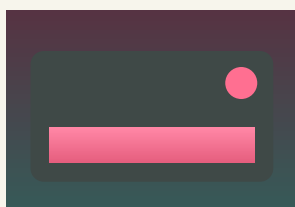
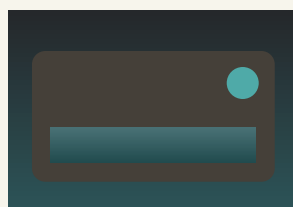
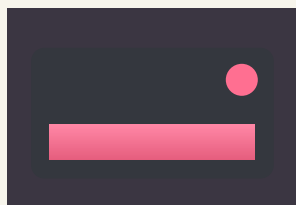
SEARCH

Ctrl+F	Find / search
F3 / Shift+F3	Next / previous result
Enter / Shift+Enter	Next / previous result
Ctrl+A	Select all text on page
Shift+Click	Add to selection

APPEARANCE

Thirteen themes

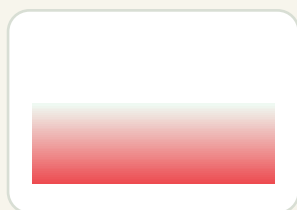
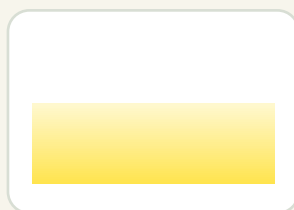
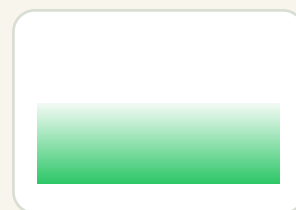
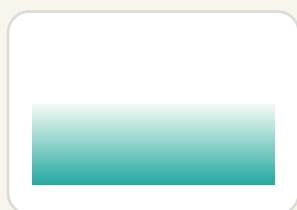
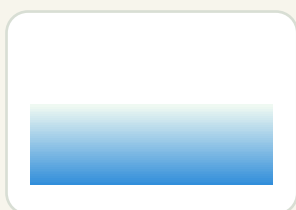
Choose a look without restarting. The cards below sample the theme resources in this checkout.

**Dark****Light****Black****98SE****Blood****Greed****Cyanotic****Ectoplasm****Decay****Malaise****Sepulchre****Delirium****Mourning**

APPEARANCE

One family, many moods

Dark, Light, Black, and 98SE each accept eight accent colors: 41 combinations in total.

**Red****Orange****Yellow****Green****Teal****Blue****Purple****Magenta**

Selected surfaces use subtle gradients across the modern theme family. The 98SE base keeps its classic flat selection treatment. Sunflower yellow uses a bright gradient and dark text for contrast.

LOCALIZED

Nineteen interface locales

The language picker changes the desktop interface immediately.

☐ English	☐ Bengali
☐ Czech	☐ German
☐ Spanish	☐ French
☐ Hungarian	☐ Italian
☐ Japanese	☐ Kazakh
☒ Norwegian Bokmål	☐ Polish
☒ Brazilian Portuguese	☐ Russian
☐ Turkish	☒ Ukrainian
☐ Vietnamese	☐ Chinese (Simplified)
☐ Chinese (Traditional)	

New in this cycle: Norwegian Bokmål, Brazilian Portuguese, and Ukrainian.

COMMAND LINE

The app can work headlessly

Use the portable executable or the installed application from PowerShell or cmd.

MERGE

```
KillerPDF.exe --merge out.pdf a.pdf b.pdf
```

EXTRACT

```
KillerPDF.exe --extract-pages in.pdf 1-3,5 out.pdf
```

OCR

```
KillerPDF.exe --ocr scan.pdf searchable.pdf --lang eng
```

RENDER

```
KillerPDF.exe --to-image in.pdf images\ --dpi 300
```

HELP

```
KillerPDF.exe --help
```

INTERACTIVE SAMPLE

Fill this page in KillerPDF

The fields below are real AcroForm widgets. Save a copy to try the form workflow.

Your name

What would you like to try next?

☐

I saved a completed form.

This demonstration is intentionally small. It verifies text fields and a checkbox without asking you to enter sensitive information.

KEEP EXPLORING

Made for the PDFs you have.

Open source. Local. Built for Windows.

Help and keyboard map

<https://killerpdf.net/help.html>

Technical guide

<https://killerpdf.net/technical.html>

Source code

<https://github.com/SteveTheKiller/KillerPDF>